ADVERTISING UNPLUGGED

BRAND TEMPLATE

Customer Persona Builder

CUSTOMER PERSONA BUILDER

DEMOGRAPHICS

PERSONA NAME

Marketing Maria

AGE RANGE

28-35

GENDER

Female

LOCATION

Bucharest, urban professional district

EDUCATION LEVEL

Master's in Digital Marketing, SNSPA

JOB TITLE

Marketing Manager

INDUSTRY

SaaS / B2B Technology

COMPANY SIZE

50-200 employees (Series A startup)

INCOME RANGE

€35,000-55,000 annually

FAMILY STATUS

Married, no kids, dual-income household

PSYCHOGRAPHICS

CORE VALUES

Efficiency, transparency, continuous learning, work-life balance, sustainability

PERSONALITY TRAITS

Analytical but creative, detail-oriented, cautiously optimistic, collaborative leader

LIFESTYLE

Wakes at 6:30am for yoga, commutes by metro, eats lunch at desk reading industry news. Evenings split between cooking healthy meals and scrolling LinkedIn. Weekends: brunch with friends, farmer's market, occasional hiking in the Carpathians. Reads 2-3 business books per month.

TECH ATTITUDE

Early Adopter

INFO SOURCES

LinkedIn daily, Marketing Brew newsletter, HubSpot Academy courses, Reply All podcast, industry webinars monthly

SOCIAL BEHAVIOR

Active LinkedIn poster (2-3x/week), shares industry insights with commentary. Instagram consumer (rarely posts). Lurks on Reddit r/marketing. No TikTok. Joined 3 Slack communities for marketing professionals.

PROFESSIONAL ASPIRATIONS

VP of Marketing within 3 years, eventually CMO at a mid-stage startup. Wants to build a marketing team from 3 to 15 people.

PERSONAL INTERESTS

Specialty coffee, indoor plants, hiking, sustainable fashion, cooking Mediterranean food, photography

INFLUENCES

Rand Fishkin, Ann Handley, local Romanian marketing leaders on LinkedIn, her former professor at SNSPA

RISK TOLERANCE

3

GOALS CHALLENGES

PRIMARY GOAL

Increase qualified lead generation by 50% in the next 6 months while reducing CAC by 20%

SECONDARY GOALS

1. Build a content engine that generates organic traffic consistently
2. Prove marketing ROI to the CEO with clear attribution data
3. Hire and onboard 2 new marketing team members

BIGGEST FRUSTRATION

Too many tools that don't integrate well — spending 30% of time on manual reporting instead of strategy

DAILY CHALLENGES

Context-switching between 6+ marketing tools, defending marketing budget in weekly leadership meetings, keeping up with algorithm changes across 4 social platforms, managing freelancers across time zones

KEEPS UP AT NIGHT

That the company will cut the marketing budget before the long-term content strategy shows results

EASIER LIFE

One unified marketing platform with real attribution that the CEO can check without asking me for reports

GOOGLE 2AM

How to prove marketing ROI to CEO, marketing attribution models that actually work, is content marketing dead in 2026

SUCCESS METRIC

Pipeline generated (€ value), Marketing Qualified Leads per month, CAC by channel, Content engagement rate

FAILURE FEAR

Getting budget cut after 6 months because the board doesn't see enough pipeline from marketing

UNMET NEED

Affordable enterprise-grade marketing analytics that a 3-person team can actually set up and maintain without a data engineer

BUYING JOURNEY

AWARENESS TRIGGER

Missed the quarterly pipeline target, CEO asked 'what is marketing actually doing?'

RESEARCH BEHAVIOR

Starts with Google search, reads 3-4 comparison articles, checks G2 reviews, asks LinkedIn network for recommendations, watches 2-3 demo videos, requests a free trial before any sales call

DECISION CRITERIA

ROI proof from similar-stage companies, ease of setup (under 2 weeks), integrations with HubSpot and Salesforce, pricing transparent and predictable, responsive support team

KEY OBJECTIONS

1. We can't afford to rip and replace our current stack
2. Will this actually integrate with what we have?
3. My team is too small to learn another tool
4. What happens when we outgrow this?

DECISION TIMELINE

1-3 months

DECISION INFLUENCERS

CEO (budget approval), CTO (technical fit), sales lead (pipeline alignment)

BUYING CHANNEL

Sales call/demo

BUDGET AUTHORITY

Needs manager approval

COMPETITOR ALTERNATIVES

HubSpot (too expensive at scale), Google Analytics 4 (too complex), Mixpanel (too product-focused), manual spreadsheets (current painful solution)

DEAL BREAKERS

No free trial, annual-only contracts, no HubSpot integration, unclear pricing page

COMMUNICATION

CONTENT FORMAT

Short case studies (5-min read), video testimonials (2-min), interactive ROI calculators, comparison guides

PREFERRED CHANNEL

LinkedIn for discovery, email for nurturing, blog for deep dives

TONE RESONATES

Data-driven & analytical

ACTION TRIGGER

See results in 30 days or your money back — backed by case study from a similar-size company

CONTENT TURNOFFS

Clickbait headlines, fake urgency, stock photography, content that talks about features without showing outcomes

EMAIL FREQUENCY

Weekly

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Active in Marketing Ops Slack community, attends Women in Marketing Romania meetups quarterly, lurks in SaaS marketing subreddit

EVENT PREFERENCES

Online webinars (can attend from desk), annual marketing conferences (1-2 per year), local meetups (monthly)

LANGUAGE LEVEL

Industry jargon OK

CTA STYLE

Medium (get started, try free)

BRAND RELATIONSHIP

BRAND AWARENESS

Vaguely aware

FIRST IMPRESSION

Looks polished but I'd want to see case studies from companies my size before I take it seriously

TRUST BUILDERS

1. Case study from a 50-200 person SaaS company in CEE
2. Real customer testimonials with names and faces
3. Transparent pricing page (no 'contact sales' for basic plans)
4. Published integration documentation
5. Active response to G2 reviews

RECOMMEND TRIGGER

After using it for 3 months and seeing measurable improvement in pipeline attribution

IDEAL RELATIONSHIP

Advisory/consultative

PERSONA QUOTE

I don't need another dashboard — I need something that tells my CEO exactly which marketing dollars turned into pipeline, without me spending 4 hours building the report.

AVATAR DESCRIPTION

Professional woman, early 30s, dark hair in a neat bun, wearing a navy blazer over a white t-shirt. Sitting at a clean desk with a MacBook, a specialty coffee mug, and a small succulent plant. Confident but approachable expression.

PERSONA CREATED BY

Gabriel Eremia, March 2026

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